

KOALA

The sole member of the family Phascolarctidae, the koala is adept at climbing because of its powerful forearms, opposable fingers and toes, and sharp, curved claws. It sleeps for up to 20 hours each day because its diet of eucalyptus leaves is low in nutrients.



dense
fur

large, white,
rounded ears

65–82 cm
26–32 in

KOALA

Phascolarctos cinereus
Feeding almost exclusively on eucalyptus leaves, the koala lives in forest and woodland in E. Australia. It is solitary and nocturnal.

long, curved
claws

WOMBATS

Stocky marsupials with a short tail and short limbs, wombats have large forepaws and long claws for burrowing. The family Vombatidae feed on coarse grass, which they grind using strong jaws, and digest with an elongated gut.



90–115 cm
35–45 in

COMMON WOMBAT

Vombatus ursinus
Found in forest, heathland, and coastal scrub in S.E. Australia, this species is capable of digging tunnels up to 200 m (655 ft) long.



silky fur mottled
brown and grey

SOUTHERN HAIRY-NOSED WOMBAT

Lasiorhinus latifrons

An inhabitant of central southern Australia, this wombat lives colonially in warrens but feeds alone.

84–111 cm
33–43 in

PYGMY POSSUMS

These small, nocturnal marsupials with a prehensile tail are omnivorous, feeding on insects, fruits, nectar, and pollen. Four species of the family Burramyidae are endemic to Australia; the fifth lives in Australia and New Guinea.

10.5 cm
4¼ in

LONG-TAILED PYGMY POSSUM

Cercartetus caudatus

This arboreal marsupial is found in temperate rainforest in New Guinea and N.E. Queensland.



10–13 cm
4–5 in

dull,
greyish brown
upperparts

MOUNTAIN PYGMY POSSUM

Burramys parvus

A ground-dweller of rocky, upland habitats in Australia, the mountain pygmy possum hibernates under snow for several months during winter.



RINGTAILS AND RELATIVES

This family consists of ringtail possums and the lemur-like greater glider. The Pseudocheiridae are all arboreal and are specialized leaf-eaters. They have an enlarged pouch at the start of the large intestine for fermentation of cellulose from their diet.



29–35 cm
11½–14 in

COMMON RINGTAIL

Pseudocheirus peregrinus

This agile marsupial lives in a wide range of habitats in E. Australia and Tasmania. It has become a pest in New Zealand.



35–55 cm
14–22 in

LEMUROID RING- TAILED POSSUM

Hemibelideus lemuroides

Found only in a small area of rainforest in N.E. Queensland, Australia, this species of ringtail is nocturnal.